THE B-SCHOOL PLAYBOOK IS CHANGING

TRADITIONAL APPROACH	EMERGING APPROACH
Placement was the end goal	Entrepreneurship is becoming another legitimate career pathway
Corporate career was seen as the destination	Corporate experience can become 'founder training'
Entrepreneurship often pursued after years of work experience	Entrepreneurial ambition is entering the campus conversation earlier
Learning centred on classroom and corporate recruitment	Learning increasingly includes incubators, mentors, investors and founders
Success measured by jobs and compensation	Success increasingly also includes ventures, scale, fund raising, revenue and impact



"What has changed is the way students perceive entrepreneurship. It is increasingly being seen not merely as an alternative to employment but as a leadership pathway"

(FR.) SEBASTIAN GEORGE S. J.
DIRECTOR, XLRI—XAVIER SCHOOL OF MANAGEMENT, JAMSHEDPUR

experimentation get 15-20% hiring premiums, as per the study.

"The corporate pathway is increasingly equipping MBAs with capabilities that are equally relevant to building and scaling businesses," says Neelesh Gupta, Partner, Deloitte India.

In effect, the corporate ladder itself is becoming a kind of entrepreneurial training ground.

Yet there is a catch. The gap between wanting to build a company and building one that actually earns money remains substantial. GUESSS found that 32.5% of Indian students were nascent entrepreneurs, while only 4.8% were running revenue-generating businesses.

That is where the expanding ecosystem will face its real test.

But are students increasingly arriving at B-schools with an entrepreneurial ambition, or is the interest in entrepreneurship being created during their time on campus? George believes it is a combination of both. "Some students arrive with a clearly articulated entrepreneurial ambition, often based on a problem they have encountered through their professional or personal experiences. Others discover entrepreneurship during their time at the school," he adds.

IIM Kozhikode's incubator programme IIMK LIVE, launched in 2013, has evolved into a platform offering support from ideation and incubation to fundraising. Similarly, XLRI's XCEED brings together mentors, investors, industry leaders, and alumni, while its NABARD-supported rural incubation programme works with ventures across 12 eastern and north-eastern states.

For B-schools, that may ultimately prove a more meaningful measure of their entrepreneurial push than the number of start-up competitions, incubators or founder clubs. The test will be whether ideas survive beyond campus.

Chatterjee believes it will take two to five years to see the full impact of many ventures emerging from the ecosystem.

That is perhaps why the most interesting change is not that every MBA student now wants to become a founder. Most do not. It is that the definition of a successful MBA career is becoming broader.

As Chatterjee puts it, there is a "start-up infection". Whether it eventually becomes a fever, he says, is a matter of time. BT

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